CALIFORNIA PUBLIC RECORDS ACT REQUEST

TRH 26-11 / TRE 26-09 | LA28 eventing cross-country course at Santa Anita Park

STATUTORY ACTION	Assign a tracking number; preserve responsive records; issue the determination required by Government Code section 7922.535 within 10 days; state the estimated availability date; and begin rolling electronic production.

29 August 2026

VIA EMAIL TO PUBLICRECORDS@ARCADIACA.GOV

Linda Rodriguez, CMC, City Clerk
Rachelle Arellano, CMC, Assistant City Clerk
City of Arcadia
240 West Huntington Drive
Arcadia, California 91007

Re: California Public Records Act Request - TRH 26-11, TRE 26-09, and the LA28 Eventing Cross-Country Course at Santa Anita Park

Pursuant to the California Public Records Act, Government Code section 7920.000 et seq., I request electronic copies of the records described below concerning Protected Healthy Tree Removal Permit TRH 26-11, Protected Tree Encroachment Permit TRE 26-09, and the proposed LA28 eventing cross-country course at Santa Anita Park. The requested period is 1 January 2025 through the date of the City's search unless a category expressly requires an earlier record to explain a current plan, agreement, asset, or decision.

This request covers records created, received, transmitted, possessed, controlled, or maintained by the City, including records held for the City by consultants or contractors. It includes writings in every form recognized by the Act, including emails and attachments, text or messaging records used for City business, memoranda, notes, meeting records, presentations, spreadsheets, databases, geospatial files, CAD or plan files, photographs, videos, contracts, draft and final reports, native electronic files, and metadata ordinarily maintained with those records.

Please produce every version of the cross-country course map, route, alignment, site plan, grading plan, drainage plan, obstacle plan, access plan, operational plan, construction plan, tree-impact plan, tree-protection plan, and restoration plan. This category includes rejected, superseded, preliminary, annotated, redlined, and presentation versions, as well as records showing when, by whom, and why each version was changed.

Please produce every alternatives analysis, alternatives matrix, design narrative, feasibility study, comparison, decision log, cost or schedule comparison, tree-impact count, presentation, meeting record, or communication that evaluates or rejects a materially different course design. This category includes every record concerning a zero-removal, no-removal, tree-exclusion, hardscape-first, parking-lot, infield, track, turf, temporary-overlay, or other lower-impact route, whether or not the exact terminology was used.

Please produce every record identifying the mandatory technical criteria applied to route selection or tree conflicts, including FEI or Olympic sporting requirements; horse and rider welfare criteria; course length, speed, grade, turning radius, obstacle, sightline, footing, surface-transition, warm-up, veterinary, emergency, fire, evacuation, accessibility, security, broadcast, spectator, stabling, circulation, grading, drainage, utility, construction, and restoration requirements; and any distinction between mandatory requirements and preferences relating to cost, schedule, aesthetics, broadcast, hospitality, spectator experience, construction convenience, or post-Games use.

Please produce every tree-specific record for the 34 proposed removals and 45 proposed protected-zone encroachments, including survey data, species, trunk diameter, age estimate, condition, protected-zone geometry, canopy, known root structure, photographs, arborist analysis, biological analysis, grading or utility conflict, proposed work inside the protected zone, attempted redesign, mitigation, monitoring, and the technical requirement asserted to remain after redesign. Please include all structured or geospatial source data used to generate tree maps or impact counts.

Please produce every record concerning the completeness, processing, notice, and decision schedule for TRH 26-11 and TRE 26-09, including the application, all supplements, completeness correspondence, the date each application was deemed complete, notices of pending decision, mailing lists and declarations of mailing, public comments, staff analysis, consultant review, draft findings, conditions, proposed decisions, environmental-review status, and appeal instructions. Please include records concerning the August 27, 2026 community meeting and any decision to modify, maintain, withdraw, or resubmit either application after that meeting.

Please produce every record concerning the City project webpage and its technical links, including the posting, migration, storage, removal, failure, repair, testing, or replacement of the linked course map, arborist assessment, biological resources

assessment, precise grading plan, and rough grading plan. As of 29 August 2026, each of those five linked files returned a 404 error. This category includes help-desk tickets, web-vendor communications, file paths, upload records, change logs, and records showing when the City knew or was advised that any file was inaccessible.

Please produce every CEQA or other environmental-review record concerning the permits or cross-country course, including preliminary reviews, exemption or categorical-exemption analyses, notices, memoranda, consultant communications, biological and arboricultural review, cumulative-impact analysis, mitigation measures, agency comments, and decisions about the scope or form of environmental review.

Please produce every record concerning replacement trees and mitigation, including the proposal to plant 34 new trees, any request or proposal to depart from the default minimum of two new 24-inch-box trees for each protected tree approved for removal, the identity of the official exercising modification authority, and the findings, calculations, species, sizes, locations, irrigation, establishment period, mortality replacement, security, long-term maintenance, canopy projections, habitat assumptions, and valuation supporting the proposed mitigation.

Please produce every agreement, memorandum of understanding, term sheet, letter agreement, budget, cost estimate, reimbursement arrangement, procurement record, funding commitment, sponsorship or vendor contribution, in-kind contribution, insurance provision, ownership term, useful-life analysis, maintenance obligation, restoration obligation, legacy-use term, public-access term, scheduling right, revenue arrangement, or valuation concerning the course or any associated improvement. The production should identify what is temporary, what is permanent, what is convertible, who pays for each component, who owns it after the Games, who decides whether it remains, and who controls post-Games operation and revenue.

Please produce every record concerning statements or analyses that the course will remain after the 2028 Games or will allow Santa Anita Park to host additional forms of horse sport, as well as every record concerning post-Games events, commercial use, public access, easements, trail rights, bicycle rights, walking rights, family access, free community use, ticketing, admission, closures, maintenance, security, or removal. Please include every record classifying the project under LA28's no-permanent-build or no-new-permanent-venues representations.

Please search Development Services, Planning, Engineering, Transportation, Public Works, Fire, the City Manager's Office, the City Clerk's Office, the City Attorney's Office to the extent records are nonprivileged or reasonably segregable, Information Technology, and all City consultants or contractors participating in the project or maintaining responsive records. External correspondents and custodians should include Santa Anita Park, 1/ST, LA28, FEI, course-design personnel, architects, civil engineers, surface and footing consultants, arborists, biologists, contractors, venue-infrastructure partners, and sponsors or vendors involved in the project.

Please produce records electronically and on a rolling basis. Where records are maintained in native form, please provide the native file with ordinary metadata rather than a flattened screenshot or image-only PDF. Please preserve email families with their attachments, provide plans at original available resolution, and provide spreadsheets, databases, geospatial files, presentations, and drawings in the format in which they are maintained or in a reasonably usable export that preserves fields, layers, formulas, and relationships. Please do not deduplicate materially different versions or omit attachments merely because the parent communication is produced.

If any record contains exempt material, please redact only the exempt portion, produce all reasonably segregable nonexempt material, and identify the specific statutory basis for each withholding. If the City asserts privilege, please provide a privilege log sufficient to identify the date, author, recipients, general subject, and privilege asserted without disclosing privileged substance. If the City contends that a requested record does not exist or is not in its possession, please identify the category and the offices, custodians, systems, and search terms used.

Government Code section 7922.535 requires the City, within 10 days of receipt, to determine whether this request seeks disclosable records in its possession, promptly notify me of the determination and reasons, and state the estimated date and time when the records will be made available. Any extension based on unusual circumstances must be provided in writing and may not extend the determination by more than 14 days. Please provide the request tracking number, the date the 10-day determination period expires, the responsible records coordinator, and the anticipated rolling-production schedule.

Please contact me before treating any category as unclear or unduly burdensome. I am willing to discuss sequencing or technically sensible search methods, but I do not consent to closure, indefinite delay, or unilateral narrowing of the request. Please preserve all potentially responsive records, including drafts, superseded plans, and electronically stored information, pending completion of production and any related administrative proceedings.

Respectfully,

Jonathan Sandhu
jvssandhu@gmail.com
Requester